

To Sketch Curves by hand we use the following Checklist to get information.

Note, Not every step will be used.

A. Domain:

Start by finding the domain of the function so you know what values of x are relevant.

B. Intercepts:

- Find y -intercept by evaluating $f(0)$
- Find x -intercepts by solving $f(x)=0$
 - Can be skipped if calculations are difficult.

C. Symmetry

- Even: If $f(-x)=f(x)$, then f is even and symmetric over x -axis
- Odd: If $f(-x)=-f(x)$, then f is odd and has 180° symmetry
- Periodic: If $f(x+p)=f(x)$ for some p , then the function is periodic.

D. Asymptotes:

• Horizontal: Where $\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} f(x) = L$ or $\lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} f(x) = L$

• Vertical: Values $x=a$ where one of

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow a^+} f(x) = \infty, \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow a^+} f(x) = -\infty$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow a^-} f(x) = \infty, \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow a^-} f(x) = -\infty$$

E. Intervals of Increasing/Decreasing

Compute $f'(x)$ and find where $f'(x) > 0$, and $f'(x) < 0$.

↕ often done together

F. Local Max and Min

• Find values c where $f'(c) = 0$ or DNE

• Use Part E to decide if c relates to a max or min.

G. Concavity and Points of Inflection first find $f''(x) = 0$ or DNE

• Find $f''(x)$ and find where $f''(x) > 0$ and $f''(x) < 0$

Concave UP

Concave down

• The points Concavity Changes are Points of Inflection

H. Sketch the Curve

Ex: Sketch $f(x) = \frac{2x^2}{x^2-1}$

A. Domain is $(-\infty, -1) \cup (-1, 1) \cup (1, \infty)$

B. y-intercept is 0 , x -intercept is 0

C. $f(-x) = \frac{(-x)^2}{(-x)^2-1} = \frac{x^2}{x^2-1} = f(x)$, so the function is even

$$D. \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{2x^2}{x^2-1} \cdot \frac{\frac{1}{x^2}}{\frac{1}{x^2}} = \lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{2}{1 - \frac{1}{x^2}} = 2$$

$$\cdot \lim_{x \rightarrow -\infty} \frac{2x^2}{x^2-1} = 2 \text{ as well}$$

• Since denominator is 0 when $x = \pm 1$, we check

$$\cdot \lim_{x \rightarrow 1^-} \frac{2x^2}{x^2-1} = -\infty$$

if $x \rightarrow 1^-$, $x < 1$
so $x^2 - 1 < 0$

$$\cdot \lim_{x \rightarrow 1^+} \frac{2x^2}{x^2-1} = \infty$$

$$\cdot \lim_{x \rightarrow -1^-} \frac{2x^2}{x^2-1} = \infty$$

$$\cdot \lim_{x \rightarrow -1^+} \frac{2x^2}{x^2-1} = -\infty$$

Horizontal Asymptote: $y = 2$

Vertical Asymptote: $x = -1$, $x = +1$

E. Inc/Dec

$$f'(x) = \frac{(x^2-1)(4x) - (2x^2)(2x)}{(x^2-1)^2} = \frac{-4x}{(x^2-1)^2}$$

$f'(x)=0$ if $x=0$, $f'(x)$ DNE if $x=\pm 1$

	$-4x$	$(x^2-1)^2$	$f'(x)$	Inc/dec
$(-\infty, -1)$	+	+	+	Inc
$(-1, 0)$	+	+	+	Inc
$(0, 1)$	-	+	-	Dec
$(1, \infty)$	-	+	-	Dec

Inc: $(-\infty, -1) \cup (-1, 0)$

Dec: $(0, 1) \cup (1, \infty)$

F. from Part E,

$(0, 0)$ is local maximum

G. Concavity

$$f''(x) = \frac{(x^2-1)^2(-4) - (-4x)(2(x^2-1))(2x)}{(x^2-1)^4}$$
$$= \frac{12x^2 + 4}{(x^2-1)^3}$$

$$f''(x) = 0 \text{ never} \sim 12x^2 + 4 > 0$$

$$f''(x) \text{ DNE if } x = \pm 1$$

	$12x^2 + 4$	$(x^2 - 1)^3$	$f''(x)$	Concavity
$(-\infty, -1)$	+	+	+	UP
$(-1, 1)$	+	-	-	Down
$(1, \infty)$	+	+	+	UP

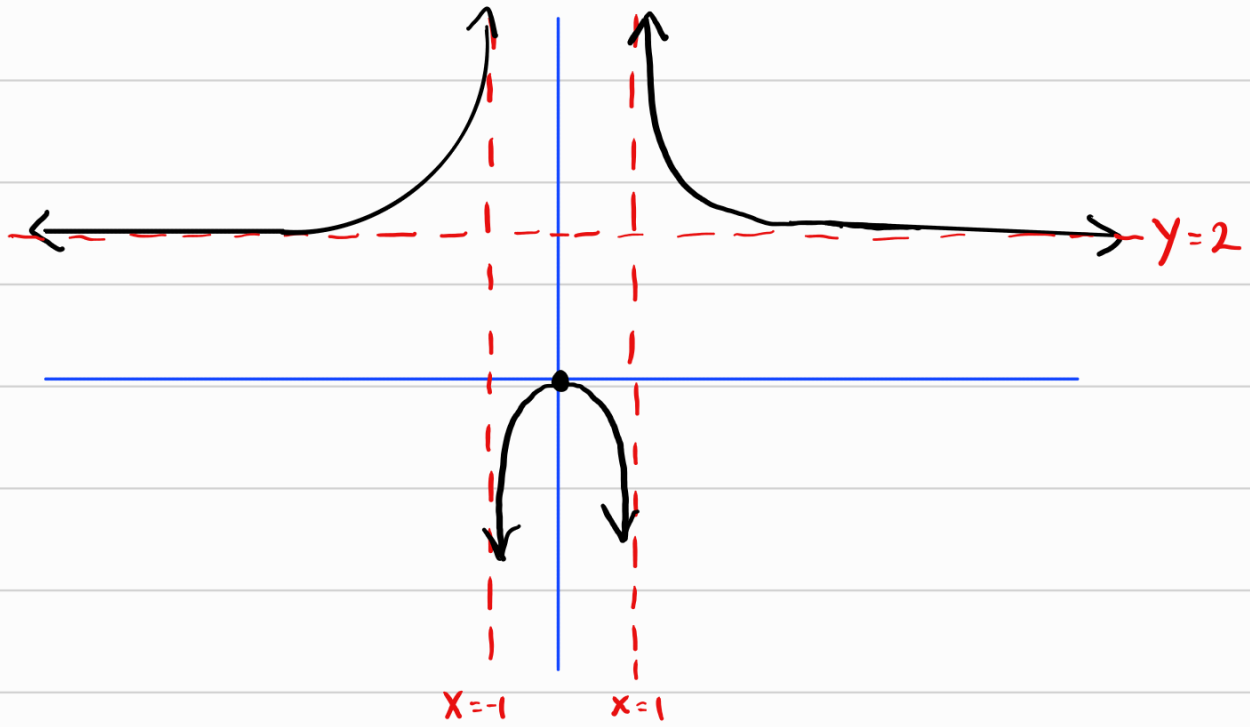
$$CU: (-\infty, -1) \cup (1, \infty)$$

$$CD: (-1, 1)$$

Points of Inflection

Don't exist as ± 1 aren't in domain of f .

H. Sketch



Ex: Sketch $f(x) = \frac{x^2}{\sqrt{x+1}}$

A. Domain is $(-1, \infty)$

B. x -intercept is 0, y -intercept is 0

$$C. f(-x) = \frac{(-x)^2}{\sqrt{-x+1}} = \frac{x^2}{\sqrt{-x+1}} \neq f(x) \text{ nor } -f(x)$$

No Symmetry

D. Asymptotes

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow \infty} \frac{x^2}{\sqrt{x+1}} = \infty$$

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow -1^+} \frac{x^2}{\sqrt{x+1}} = \infty$$

Horizontal Asymptote: None

Vertical Asymptote: $x = -1$

E. Inc/Dec

$$f'(x) = \frac{(x+1)^{1/2}(2x) - x^2 \frac{1}{2}(x+1)^{-1/2}}{(x+1)} = \frac{3x^2 + 4x}{2(x+1)^{3/2}} = \frac{x(3x+4)}{2(x+1)^{3/2}}$$

$$f'(x) = 0 \text{ if } x = 0 \text{ or } x = -\frac{4}{3}$$

$$\text{DNE if } x = -1$$

$-\frac{4}{3}$ is in domain

	x	$3x+4$	$2(x+1)^{3/2}$	$f'(x)$	
$(-1, 0)$	-	+	+	-	Dec
$(0, \infty)$	+	+	+	+	Inc

Decreasing $(-1, 0)$

Increasing $(0, \infty)$

F. Max/min

f' changes from negative to positive at 0

So $(0, 0)$ is minimum

G. Concavity

$$f''(x) = \frac{2(x+1)^{3/2}(6x+4) - 3(3x^2+4x)(x+1)^{1/2}}{4(x+1)^3} = \frac{3x^2+8x+8}{4(x+1)^{5/2}}$$

$f''(x)$ DNE if $x = -1$

$$= 0 \text{ if } 3x^2 + 8x + 8 = 0$$

Quadratic Formula

$$x = \frac{-8 \pm \sqrt{8^2 - 4 \cdot 3 \cdot 8}}{2 \cdot 3}$$

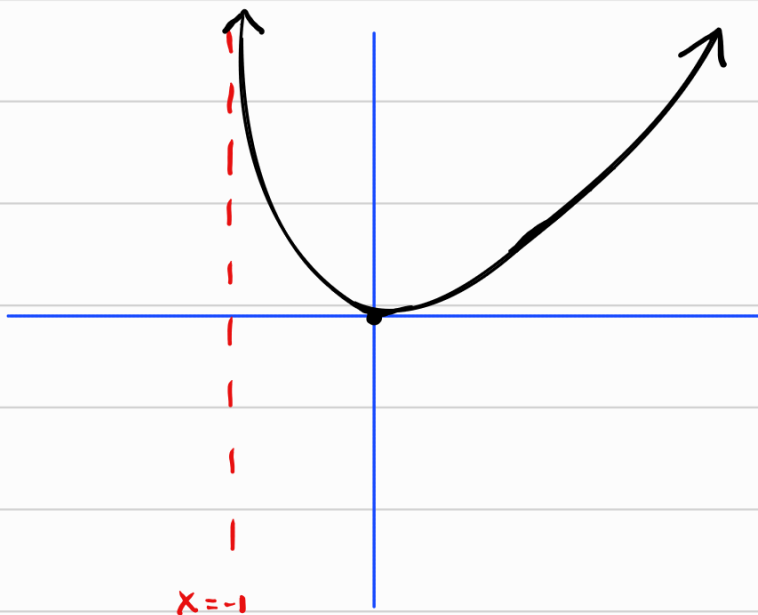
Not real
as $8^2 - 4 \cdot 3 \cdot 8$
 $= -32$

So $f''(x) \neq 0$

So, there won't be any change in concavity and we
check $f''(x) > 0$ on $(-1, \infty) \sim$ just check $f''(0)$

So, f is Concave up on $(-1, \infty)$

H. Sketch



Ex: Sketch $f(x) = \frac{\cos(x)}{2+\sin(x)}$

A. $2+\sin(x) \neq 0$ so domain is $\mathbb{R}$

B. $f(0) = \frac{1}{2}$, $\cos(x) = 0$ if $x = \frac{\pi}{2} + n\pi$

Y-intercept $\frac{1}{2}$

X-intercept $\frac{\pi}{2} + n\pi$

C. $f(-x) = \frac{\cos(-x)}{2+\sin(-x)} = \frac{\cos(x)}{2-\sin(x)} \neq f(x)$ nor $f(-x)$

However, $f(x+2\pi) = \frac{\cos(x+2\pi)}{2+\sin(x+2\pi)} = \frac{\cos(x)}{2+\sin(x)} = f(x)$

So f is periodic with period 2π

D. f is periodic, so $\lim_{x \rightarrow \pm\infty} f(x)$ DNE

The denominator is never 0 ($2+\sin(x) \neq 0$) so there are no vertical asymptotes

No Asymptotes

E. Inc/dec

$$f'(x) = \frac{(2+\sin(x))(-\sin(x)) - \cos(x)(\cos(x))}{(2+\sin(x))^2} = -\frac{2\sin(x)+1}{(2+\sin(x))^2}$$

$$f'(x) = 0 \quad \text{if} \quad \sin(x) = -\frac{1}{2} \rightarrow x = \frac{7\pi}{6} + 2n\pi, \frac{11\pi}{6} + 2n\pi$$

$f'(x)$ always exists.

look at one period

	-1	$2\sin(x)+1$	$(2+\sin(x))^2$	$f'(x)$
$(0, \frac{7\pi}{6})$	-	+	+	-
$(\frac{7\pi}{6}, \frac{11\pi}{6})$	-	-	+	+
$(\frac{11\pi}{6}, 2\pi)$	-	+	+	-

Inc: $(\frac{7\pi}{6}, \frac{11\pi}{6})$
Dec: $(0, \frac{7\pi}{6}) \cup (\frac{11\pi}{6}, 2\pi)$

F.

Max $(\frac{11\pi}{6} + 2n\pi, \frac{\sqrt{3}}{3})$ ↖ Periodic

Min $(\frac{7\pi}{6} + 2n\pi, -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{3})$

G. Concavity

$$f''(x) = - \frac{2\cos(x)(2+\sin(x))^2 - 2(2\sin(x)+1)(2+\sin(x))(\cos(x))}{(2+\sin(x))^4}$$

$$= - \frac{2\cos(x)(1-\sin(x))}{(2+\sin(x))^3}$$

$$f''(x) = 0 \quad \text{if} \quad \cos(x) = 0 \quad \text{or} \quad \sin(x) = 1$$

$$\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{3\pi}{2}$$

$$\frac{\pi}{2}$$

— in one period

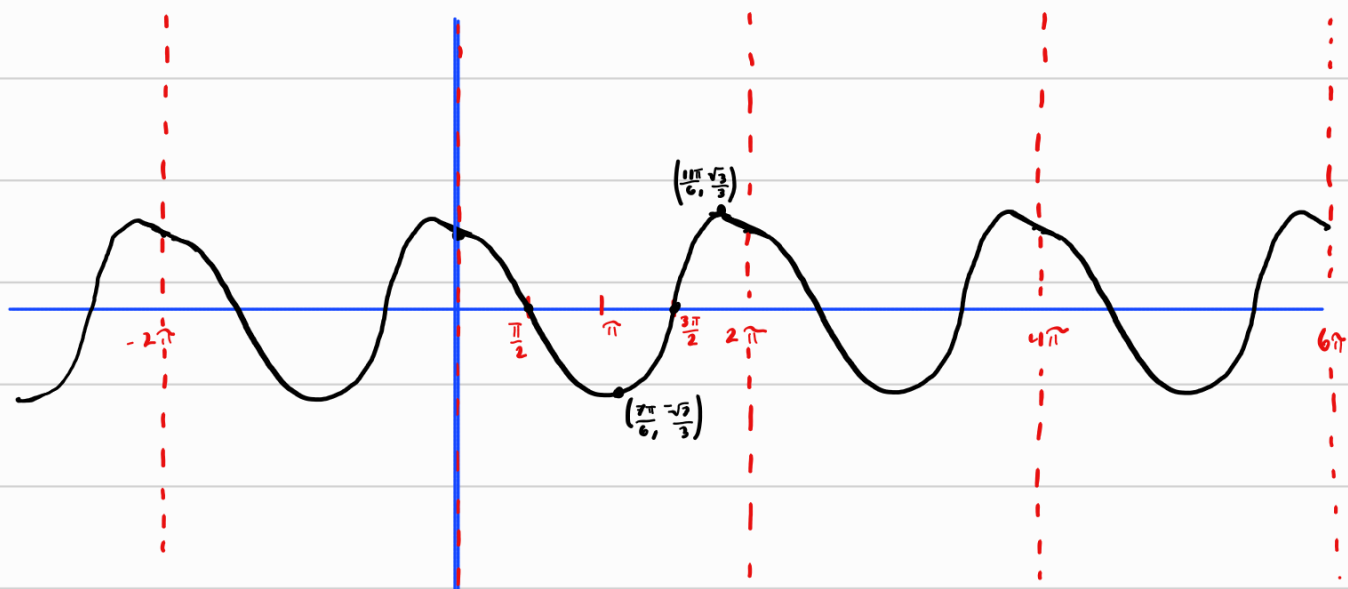
	-1	$2\cos(x)$	$1-\sin(x)$	$(2+\sin(x))^3$	$f''(x)$
$(0, \frac{\pi}{2})$	$-$	$+$	$+$	$+$	$-$
$(\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{3\pi}{2})$	$-$	$-$	$+$	$+$	$+$
$(\frac{3\pi}{2}, 2\pi)$	$-$	$+$	$+$	$+$	$-$

Concave UP : $(\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{3\pi}{2})$

Concave Down : $(0, \frac{\pi}{2}) \cup (\frac{3\pi}{2}, 2\pi)$

Point of Inflection: $(\frac{\pi}{2} + 2n\pi, 0), (\frac{3\pi}{2} + 2n\pi, 0)$

H. Sketch



Periodic Sc image
repeats every 2π